SHAME-05 | Therapist only - all age groups

Connection and support by choice

1 | Purpose, fit and boundaries

Purpose of this unit

Identify a supportive person or setting and choose a request for help at the participant's preferred level. The outcome is a way to receive connection or support without having to disclose the source of shame.

Choice and adaptation

Choose this sheet following professional assessment and with consent. The person may skip questions, answer aloud, or choose another tool. This is proposed original material for review; it provides no score, diagnosis, or promise of an outcome.

Boundaries specific to this unit

There is no obligation to tell a secret, detail harm, forgive, or contact a particular relative. There is no promise that all sharing will be well received or of absolute confidentiality. Assess safety, power relationships, and sharing boundaries before contact.

Reusing existing material

SHAME-03 offers respectful self-regard and SHAME-04 explores repair. Here, focus on receiving support without making it conditional on repair or disclosure.

A fictional example for discussion

Fictional example: Michal wants company after a difficult day but does not want to give details. She chooses to ask for a conversation about an everyday topic and clarifies what she feels comfortable sharing.

> Draft for administrator review. Clinical review and final rights approval are still pending.

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Working together with the worksheet

2 | A conversation about one situation

Opening

Choose a situation the person wants to explore. It need not be the hardest situation. Check that the question is understood and the wording fits the person; their account comes before the therapist's interpretation.

1 | Question for discussion

What kind of support do I need right now?

2 | Question for discussion

Who can offer it while respecting my boundaries?

3 | Question for discussion

What information is needed, and what do I choose not to share?

4 | Question for discussion

How will I make a limited request for help?

5 | Question for discussion

What will I do if the response is unavailable or disrespectful?

Closing

Summarize what became clearer and what remains open. Use the existing SES-S01 and SES-S02 for the session framework. There is no need to repeat an assessment or plan already recorded.

Possible difficulties

If a response is disrespectful, do not conclude that the participant asked incorrectly. Explore boundaries and other support instead of requiring further disclosure.

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Adapting for four age groups

3 | Age is a starting point, not an assumption about ability

CH | Children, approximately ages 6 to 11

Help identify a suitable, available adult without expecting the child to assess safety alone. Explain privacy limits in simple language; sharing with a group is not mandatory.

Offer one question at a time with little writing. Adult support must not replace the child's own voice.

TE | Adolescents, approximately ages 12 to 17

Explore options within or outside the family according to the setting. Do not promise absolute confidentiality or force contact with a peer.

Agree in advance what will be shared and with whom, and explain the privacy limits in this setting. Do not promise absolute confidentiality.

AD | Adults

Allow practical, professional, or social support. A request does not require confession or a full explanation; consider availability and cost too.

OA | Older adults

Respect relationship and privacy preferences without assuming isolation. Choose company with the person, not for them; presence can be requested without discussing the difficulty.

Offer reading support, time, and conversation according to preference. Choose help from another person together with the participant, respecting their privacy.

> Each age version needs its own review. Approval of one version does not automatically approve the others.

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Practice, review and next steps

4 | Shared choice and learning from the attempt

Before offering practice sheet P

A request may be prepared only in the session, or contact chosen without discussing difficulty. There is no automatic outreach to others or obligation to give them the sheet.

At the next session

Check the fit between need and response and whether choice was preserved. Connection can support someone even when shame remains and without sharing its details.

Professional and technical records

Each version has a separate review record covering age suitability, originality, rights, and fictional filling. Reviewer and date fields remain blank until assigned. File checks or a code merge are not clinical approval. Clinical information stays only in the authorized setting, outside the code repository.

Background references

The following links were used for background only. Questions and adaptations were written afresh for the expansion plan; no questionnaire, scale, or protocol was copied. Adult sources do not validate the child versions. This material makes no claim about session count or treatment effectiveness.

www.nhs.uk/mental-health/self-help/tips-and-support/raise-low-self-esteem/
www.nhs.uk/every-mind-matters/lifes-challenges/maintaining-healthy-relationships-and-mental-wellbeing/

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